Rice beverages — rice milk: HMTc Standard

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CORRESPONDENCE

Corrections are logged publicly on the article page, each with its date, the affected value, and the source that resolved it.

KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08.

Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified standard for rice beverages (rice milk), stated as consumed. The EU sets a dedicated inorganic-arsenic maximum for non-alcoholic rice drinks (30 ppb), which is the binding arsenic control; every limit is the strictest maximum level any credible government sets for the product.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default, 8:1 basis, read-across)

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as consumed basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

ANALYTE	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	50	read-across (Mercosur)
Cadmium (Cd)	2	read-across (AU)
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	read-across (Mercosur)
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	30	government maximum level (EU 2023/915)

Mercury, total (tHg)	1	read-across (European Union)
Methylmercury (MeHg)	≤ tHg	bounded by tHg (reflex speciation)
Nickel (Ni)	250	read-across (EU 2024/1987)
Tin (Sn)	100,000	read-across (EU 2023/915)
Aluminium (Al)	200	read-across (European Union)
Total chromium (Cr)	50	read-across (AU)
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	10	read-across (CA SWRCB)

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	50	read-across (Mercosur); non-alcoholic beverages excluding juices
Cadmium (Cd)	2	read-across (AU); drinking water
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	read-across (Mercosur); non-alcoholic beverages excluding juices
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	30	government maximum level (EU 2023/915)
Mercury, total (tHg)	1	read-across (European Union); water intended for human consumption
Methylmercury (MeHg)	≤ tHg	bounded by tHg (reflex speciation)
Nickel (Ni)	250	read-across (EU 2024/1987); fruit/vegetable juices and nectars, general
Tin (Sn)	100,000	read-across (EU 2023/915); canned beverages, including canned fruit and vegetable juices, except canned dried and canned powdered products
Aluminium (Al)	200	read-across (European Union); water intended for human consumption
Total chromium (Cr)	50	read-across (AU); drinking water

4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. (2026). *Rice beverages — rice milk: HMTc standard* (Standard No. 10.83138/hmtc.std.3.rice-beverages-rice-milk). Institute of Contaminant Standards. https://doi.org/10.83138/hmtc.std.3.rice-beverages-rice-milk

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References

[1] Mercosur
Binds Pb, tAs. non-alcoholic beverages excluding juices.
READ-ACROSS

[2] AU
Binds Cd, Cr. drinking water.
READ-ACROSS

[3] European Union
Binds tHg, Al. water intended for human consumption.
READ-ACROSS

[4] EU 2024/1987
Binds Ni. fruit/vegetable juices and nectars, general.
READ-ACROSS

[5] CA SWRCB
Binds Cr-VI. public water systems in California.
READ-ACROSS

[6] EU 2023/915
Binds Sn, iAs. canned beverages, including canned fruit and vegetable juices, except canned dried and canned powdered products.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

STATUS AND LICENCE

A normative certification standard, editorially reviewed and version-controlled in-house; every value traces to a named sovereign maximum level, disclosed in the derivation. © 2026 Institute of Contaminant Standards / Heavy Metal Certified. All rights reserved.

COMPETING INTERESTS

This standard is published by the Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) program, operated by the Institute of Contaminant Standards. Its statements about government regulations, toxicology, and occurrence are sourced to the cited primary and expert-body records and to the independently maintained Heavy Metal Index; the program's own certification thresholds are not used as evidence for any factual claim made here.

DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this standard draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the standard page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/rice-beverages-rice-milk. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are

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named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.